AnyCompany Leadership Principles

How we work, how we decide, and what we expect from each other. Everyone at AnyCompany is a leader, whatever their role or title.

1. Start with the customer

We begin every decision by asking what is best for the people who use our products. We listen to customers directly, read their feedback, and visit them where they work. When a customer problem and an internal convenience conflict, the customer wins. We measure success by the problems we solve for customers, not by the features we ship.

2. Act like an owner

Owners think about the long term and don't trade lasting value for short-term results. They take responsibility for the whole outcome, not just their part of it, and never say "that's not my job". If you see something broken, fix it or make sure the right person knows about it.

3. Keep learning

We are curious and never assume we know everything. We ask questions, read widely, and learn from our mistakes and from other teams. New hires are encouraged to ask "why" as often as they need to; experienced people are expected to ask it too.

4. Make it simple

Complexity is a cost that customers and teammates pay every day. We look for the simplest solution that works, remove steps that don't add value, and explain our ideas in plain language. A simple plan that everyone understands beats a clever plan that nobody can follow.

5. Decide with data and judgment

We use data to understand problems and to check our assumptions, but we don't wait for perfect data before acting. Most decisions can be changed later, so we make them quickly and adjust. For the few decisions that are hard to reverse, we slow down and consult widely.

6. Earn trust every day

Trust is built through many small actions: doing what you said you would do, admitting mistakes early, and sharing bad news as quickly as good news. We speak honestly and respectfully, give credit to others, and assume good intent.

7. Disagree, then commit

We are expected to challenge decisions we disagree with, openly and with evidence, even when it is uncomfortable. Once a decision is made, we commit to it fully and help it succeed. We don't relitigate decisions in the hallway.

8. Hire and grow great people

Every person we hire should raise the bar for the team. Managers spend real time coaching, giving specific feedback, and creating opportunities for their people to take on bigger challenges. We celebrate when team members grow into new roles, even on other teams.

9. Insist on quality

We hold ourselves to high standards and keep raising them. We don't pass on defects to the next team or to customers. When something goes wrong, we find the root cause and fix it so it doesn't happen again, rather than looking for someone to blame.

10. Be frugal

We spend money as if it were our own. Constraints make us more inventive and self-reliant. We don't add headcount, budget, or tools when a better process would solve the problem.

11. Move with urgency

Speed matters to our customers. We prefer to deliver something useful now and improve it, rather than wait for something perfect. Taking calculated risks is part of the job, and a thoughtful failure is better than not trying.

12. Deliver results

In the end, we are measured by what we deliver. We set clear goals, focus on the inputs that matter most, and keep going when things get hard. When we fall short, we say so, explain what we learned, and make a plan to recover.

13. Look after each other and the world around us

We create a safe, inclusive workplace where everyone can do their best work. We think about the effects of our decisions on our communities and the environment, and we aim to leave things better than we found them.

Applying the principles

The principles sometimes pull in different directions: moving with urgency can conflict with insisting on quality, and frugality can conflict with growing great people. There is no formula for these tensions. Talk them through with your team, explain your reasoning, and use the customer as the tie-breaker.